

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

SATURDAY, MAY 16, 2026

Study showing transit gain wasn't shared

Blue Hill Ave. analysis affirmed bus trips would be faster, driving would be slower

By Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

For months, as officials and residents debated a controversial plan to remake Blue Hill Avenue, community meetings and government discussions have circled around the same questions: Would the plan save significant time for beleaguered bus riders, who face notoriously sluggish trips on the corridor? And, on the flip side, would it

make commutes slower for drivers?

A 1,029-page traffic analysis prepared for the MBTA last year offers some answers: Yes and yes. But the document was not shared with the public, even as the divisive project obtained tens of millions of federal dollars and moved closer to execution.

The traffic report, obtained by the Globe Thursday through a pub-

lic records request, lays out notable gains for transit users, projecting that riders on the popular 28 bus route would save as much as 10 to 15 minutes during peak hours if city and state officials go ahead with their plan to reduce traffic lanes and add a dedicated center-running bus lane. Drivers, meanwhile, would see their commutes slow, including by nearly six minutes when traveling northbound on Blue Hill Avenue during the morning rush on weekdays, according to the report. The analysis, prepared by engineering firms wsp and Fuss

& O'Neill, also details the plan's efforts to make a dangerous stretch safer for walkers and bikers, adding 24 crosswalks and 5.6 miles of bike lanes.

"In relocating bus operations to the center of the roadway, the proposed project will greatly improve the travel experience for bus riders," the report concluded. "The anticipated increases in vehicle travel time will encourage drivers to consider other modes of transportation and will ultimately help the City of Boston reach their mode

REPORT, Page A7

Insurers rebound after cuts in coverage

See benefit after tightening limits on GLP-1 payments

By Marin Wolf
GLOBE STAFF

After years of record losses, Massachusetts' largest health insurers appear to have shaken off the shock of the wildly popular but hugely expensive GLP-1 weight loss drugs, with each reporting healthy financial results on Friday for the first quarter this year.

However, that doesn't mean members are likely to see much easing in the cost of their health insurance.

Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts reported operating income of \$17.4 million in the first quarter of 2026, after losing \$9.8 million in the same period last year. Net income totaled \$59.6 million for the quarter.

Meanwhile, Point32Health, which owns Harvard Pilgrim and Tufts Health Plan, reported operating income of \$86 million for the quarter, after losing \$39 million in the same period of 2025. Point32Health has nearly 2 million members, while Blue Cross has 3 million in Massachusetts.

The turnabout for each came after both insurers ended automatic coverage of the blockbuster GLP-1 weight loss drugs such as Wegovy and Zepbound solely for the treatment of obesity. The drugs, which can cost hundreds or thousands of dollars per month without insurance, soared in popularity in recent years. They are generally still covered for patients with diabetes.

INSURERS, Page A7

A DEGREE OF CELEBRATION



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Graduates cheered after receiving their degrees during Roxbury Community College's 50th commencement ceremony on Friday. The class of 2026, at 300 graduates, was the largest in the school's recent history. **B1.**

Jurors deadlocked in Harvey Weinstein's rape retrial, forcing another mistrial in a case that has gone to trial three times so far. **A2.**

Africa's leading public health authority said that there was an outbreak of the Ebola virus in a province of Congo, with dozens of deaths and hundreds of infections suspected. **A4.**

An explosion and fire at a family-owned lumber mill in Maine killed a firefighter, injured at least 10 people, and damaged firetrucks. **B1.**

JetBlue will terminate all service to Manchester-Boston Regional Airport in New Hampshire this summer, with the airline's final flight scheduled for July 8, airport officials said. **D1.**

'We were sold something that didn't exist.'

REBECCA WANGLER, mother of a Hampshire College student

Hampshire students, parents scramble

Hefty scholarships won't follow them to new schools

By Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

AMHERST — When Lila Maher visited Hampshire College with her parents as a prospective student in 2022, they asked the admissions team some blunt questions: "Are you going to be open for the full four years? Am I going to be able to get my degree here?" she recently recalled. "And they were like, 'Absolutely.'"

But last month, Hampshire announced it would close at the end of December, suddenly rendering Maher, who just finished her second

► **A plan is forming to save the open space around the college. B1.**

year, a college student without a college — and without financial aid.

The school had offered Maher a merit award worth \$35,000 a year, which was "the only way that we felt like we could send her to Hampshire," said her mother, Joan Advent.

Several students interviewed by the Globe said they, like Maher, re-

ceived surprisingly generous scholarships, along with assurances the school was doing fine.

Now, the "experimenting college" has put these students' futures to the test.

Hampshire has transfer agreements with several partner institutions, including those in the Five College Consortium: the University of Massachusetts Amherst and Smith, Mount Holyoke, and Amherst colleges.

Still, there's no guarantee students can get into those schools. Likewise, without the kind of financial aid

HAMPSHIRE, Page A10

Refreshing a piece of history with eyes on the present

The Omni Mount Washington Resort & Spa will debut a new look this summer

By Christopher Muther
GLOBE STAFF

As she approached the Omni Mount Washington Resort & Spa for the first time, Tonya Grine felt goosebumps. Like generations before her, she was taken aback by the imposing building all in white, with the fire-engine-red roof.

"It's unlike anything I had seen," Grine said. "It's just such a striking contrast from the surroundings on the drive there. It's like, 'Oh my gosh, we've arrived.' It's like this piece of history. This legendary structure is rising in front of you."

Grine was no ordinary guest of the hotel. As senior director of interior design for the Omni Hotels company, she arrived that first time four years ago to sketch out an interior refresh of the 124-year-old Neo-Renaissance hotel, one of the last remaining grand dame

hotels from the days when monied city dwellers would take the train to rural New Hampshire to trade the soot of their gritty surroundings for the fresh air of the White Mountains.

The pressure of a multimillion-dollar renovation (Omni wouldn't reveal an exact price tag) is immense. This is a hotel where generations have come to spend their vacations, from childhood to pensioning. Holidaymakers have brought their children, their grandchildren, and sometimes even great-grandchildren to the 200-room resort.

Another 69 rooms were added during a 2021 renovation, but Michael Medeiros, managing director, said returning guests often ask to stay in the original rooms rather than in the recently opened Presidential Wing.

"So, if you have a guest who has al-

HOTEL, Page A10



OMNI MOUNT WASHINGTON RESORT & SPA

The Mount Washington Hotel circa 1920. The New Hampshire hotel has welcomed guests — and their descendants — since 1902.



Warming track

Saturday: Sunny, pleasant. High: 75-80. Low: 59-64.

Sunday: Warm, sunny. High: 82-87. Low: 55-60.

Sunrise: 5:22 Sunset: 8:00

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

VOL. 309, NO. 136

*

Suggested retail price

\$4.00



19617

0 947725 4